AI | Expert Insights

COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Vice President Digital Transformation at Accenture plc Believes Agentic AI Will Revolutionize Enterprise Automation and Enhance UiPath's Strategic Positioning

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SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The conversation covered the evolution of enterprise automation from traditional RPA to generative and agentic AI, with a focus on platform capabilities, vendor selection, and the role of orchestration layers. The discussion also compared UiPath to its main competitors in terms of reliability, usability, and strategic positioning.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Over nine years of experience in digital transformation roles focused on process automation, including extensive deployment of RPA tools such as UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, and Power Automate across approximately 20 clients in various industries.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- The expert believes the industry is rapidly shifting focus from traditional RPA to generative and agentic AI, aiming for higher automation coverage.
- They see agentic AI as a future replacement for most traditional bots, with orchestration and integration capabilities becoming increasingly critical for enterprise automation platforms.
- The expert views UiPath's position as strong but notes that marketing and ease of use are areas where competitors, especially Automation Anywhere and Microsoft Power Automate, have advantages.

TAKEAWAYS

- Traditional RPA tools have limitations, automating only 30-40% of processes, while agentic AI is expected to increase automation coverage to 70-80%.
- Agentic AI is not yet replacing traditional bots at scale but is expected to do so significantly within the next two years.
- Enterprises prefer consolidating automation around one or two major vendors, focusing on core ERP systems like SAP and Oracle for ROI.
- UiPath is seen as more robust and reliable than Power Automate, with strong customer support and better integration with major ERPs, but lags in low-code/no-code usability compared to Microsoft.
- Adding orchestration and agentic capabilities to UiPath increases customer stickiness, but higher costs of AI-based automation mean ROI considerations are critical for adoption.

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Expert Bio

Vice President Digital Transformation at Accenture plc Expert can speak to the global market. Vice President of Digital Transformation at Accenture. Reporting to the Associate Director, the expert is responsible for creating digital transformation roadmaps for clients, selecting and deploying digital platforms including robotic process automation tools, leading solution architecture for automation and ERP migrations such as SAP upgrades, supervising teams of transformation specialists and technology developers, and engaging with client C-suite stakeholders to drive program delivery. Prior to this role, the expert was the Associate Vice President of Digital Transformation at Accenture, leaving May 2026. Reporting to the Associate Director, the expert supervised transformation teams, managed multi-client digital initiatives and project delivery, mentored solution architects and developers, and delivered programs across RPA, generative AI, process mining, chatbots, and workflow automation. The expert can speak to implementing and operating RPA orchestration (UiPath Orchestrator),

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evaluating and deploying competing RPA platforms (Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, Power Automate), designing generative and agentic AI for automation use cases, process reengineering and Lean Six Sigma, process mining and analytics (Power BI, Celonis, Python), and enterprise ERP transformation and operating model design.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Thanks for taking the time to speak about the automation and enterprise automation markets. What would be helpful just to get started would be if you could just briefly walk me through your background and some of the roles you have had around enterprise automation, and in particular, how your work with UiPath has evolved over the last several years.

Expert 00:00:19

Definitely. Starting with my background, I am working for the last nine and a half years in Accenture in the digital transformation role. I am currently working as a vice president in digital transformation in Accenture. Prior to that, I worked for five years in manufacturing industry. My entire experience in Accenture is related to doing process automation through multiple levers. One of the key levers through which we do automation is with the help of RPA or the robotic process automation tools. In this RPA, we utilize different automation platforms which include UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, and Power Automate. Currently, we have also started using the generative AI and agentic AI tools.

Overall, if I talk about my experience with UiPath, when I started in 2017, at that time, I was working for a logistic-based client for Accenture, and we were handling their finance and accounting work. In that, all the automations which we deployed were based on the UiPath platform. That was from 2017 to 2019. After 2019, I started taking care of multiple client projects, and some clients had UiPath as their approved automation platform. Some clients had their competitors, which are Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism. overall, in these nine and a half years, I have worked for almost 20 different clients across all the locations and regions and for almost all different type of industries. For them, I have deployed all the automation tools.

Client 00:02:04

Super helpful background. I do want to talk about UiPath in particular, but maybe before that, just talking about the broader market, how would you describe where enterprise automation is today? Are you still seeing traditional RPA deployments growing, or has attention really shifted towards generative and agentic AI?

Expert 00:02:24

The attention has totally shifted to generative AI. Now, if we talk about the traditional RPA, traditional RPA had one basic setback, which was not allowing us to automate the activities end to end. That is, the traditional RPA could only automate those activities which were logic-based or which were following a sequence-based activities. While looking at the transaction activities when we saw in our industry, that was able to automate only 30% of the activities. At the max, 30%-40%. Remaining 70% had still to be done by people manually because they involved complex judgment-based activities of which RPA was not capable of doing.

Now, the focus is to shift towards generative AI, and not only generative AI, now the focus is to move towards agentic AI, which will be able to do judgment-based activities on its own. The objective of the industry is that they should be able to automate the activities within a range of 70%-80% in the last one and a half year.

Client 00:03:33

Got it. Which workflows that historically were hard to automate with RPA are becoming addressable now with agents? Are you seeing agents replacing traditional bots, or are they more likely coexisting within the same processes where their traditional bots are left in place and agents or deterministic RPA is on top of that?

Expert 00:03:55

When we talk about the workflows which could not be automated by the RPA agents in the past were those activities in which the user had to extract the information from multiple sources. If we talk about workflow or any ERP, automating the data extraction or data posting in workflow was comparatively easier. After the data extraction, there were a number of other tasks which the human had to do manually. Some of the tasks were opening the documents. The documents could have been in multiple formats. They could be PDF documents, XML documents, HTML documents. If the standard input was different, then people had to use judgment-based activities. Apart from that, it involved following up with multiple people on emails or getting the data from multiple ERPs.

RPA could only automate anything and everything which was related to a particular ERP, whether it is SAP or Oracle or JD. If we look at the entire day-to-day work of the human or the analyst, only 30% of their work is related to workflow. Remaining work they have to do manually

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in their shared folders or on their personal folders, which included data massaging, data interpretation, extraction of information from multiple data sources. That had been very difficult with the traditional RPA. Does that answer your question?

Client 00:05:28

Yes, it does. The second question I had was, are you seeing agents actually replacing existing traditional bots, or are they coexisting with the existing traditional bots and then expanding or enhancing the capabilities?

Expert 00:05:46

I wouldn't say that agents have started replacing traditional bot, but for the organization which are looking for digital transformation, it is in a path to replace the bots, and the objective it is currently, if we look at the ratio of bots to agentic bots, it is in the ratio of 90% to 10%, or even 95% to 5%. Our objective is that in the coming next two years, the agents should be able to replace at least 80% of the work which is being done by the bots. Only those bots which are not required to be replaced, or if the cost factor becomes very high, in those cases, we would continue to get them done by bot. Otherwise, remaining all is planned to be moved to agentic.

Client 00:06:33

Got it. That makes sense. In a typical larger enterprise customer today, do you expect several AI agents or model ecosystems to coexist, or do you think that customers are ultimately likely to consolidate around one or two major vendors for their usage?

Expert 00:06:50

Customers want us to automate it for one or two major vendors only because majority of their information is available with one or two vendors. For instance, if I will tell you the majority of an enterprise data is, whatever ERP they are using, either it is SAP or it is Oracle or whatever ERP they are using, majority of data is related to that ERP only. Customers focus on that.

If we look at the entire enterprise level, the number of systems or workflow they are using, on an average, a large enterprise may have 40-50 different workflows or enterprises they are using. They do not want to automate all of them because that will not come as a good return on investment for them as of now. They are focusing on just automating major two to three enterprise resource planning tools or the major workflows which they are using right now.

Client 00:07:43

Got it. As the number of agents and bots and models or APIs inside a workflow increases, how important does the orchestration layer become?

Expert 00:07:53

The orchestration layer becomes very important as the number of bots and AI increase because currently the objective is when the number of bots is very less, it is very easy to manage or see what those bots are doing. If the number of bots is very high, then it becomes difficult for anyone, even in the technology team, to check or validate how many bots are functioning properly and how many have stopped. That is why in most of the organization, they have also started deploying a command center.

The objective of which is a command center is a central command center in every organization through which they extract all the information from the orchestration layer on a regular basis and then see what is the success rate or the successful rate of all the bots which are running. The more the number of bots, the more important it becomes to focus on the orchestrator module.

Client 00:08:50

Makes sense. Maybe shifting to talk more about UiPath in particular, starting with their core automation, what does UiPath do materially better today than competitors like Automation Anywhere, Power Automate, or Blue Prism?

Expert 00:09:04

I will compare UiPath with its three major competitors. One is Blue Prism, one is Automation Anywhere, third is Power Automate. I will tell you where it stands in different features or functionalities. Talking about the robustness, as we all know, Blue Prism was one of the pioneers in automation, meaning robotic process automation. It was very initially everyone knew about Blue Prism only, and then UiPath and Automation Anywhere came as a key contender. Blue Prism has become outdated, and the major reason for it is it requires hard coding for a developer to do. That is why if you talk about the development effort it requires, it takes very high effort for a Blue Prism RPA automation. If you talk about UiPath and Automation Anywhere, it takes almost similar time to do the development for an automation.

If we talk about Microsoft Power Automate, the development in it could be done even faster than Automation Anywhere and Blue Prism.

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That is the development time. If we talk about the robustness or how effectively once those automations are built, then it becomes totally opposite. That is, although Blue Prism required a very hard coding and they do not have that drag and drop option to build the automation, but once their bots are built, there is just 5%-7% of the fallout, not even 5%, 2%-3% of the fallout of that bot once it is deployed. If we talk about Automation Anywhere and UiPath, even their success rate is very high, but comparatively lesser than Blue Prism. It could be within the range of 92%-95%.

Microsoft Power Automate, although the development can be done faster, its success rate is very low. Currently it is 70%-75% only. That is why when we plan to build something robust, Microsoft Power Automate is an option which we think when we do not have time to build it, and when the consequences of building the automation or failing the automation are not that great.

Client 00:11:16

We saw that you mentioned UiPath tended to be more reliable than Power Automate. What drives that difference in practice, and how important is reliability to the buying decision compared to other elements?

Expert 00:11:29

If we talk about the UiPath, its reliability is based on three factors. The first factor is like I told that the success rate or once the bot has been deployed, its fallout is very less. The second reason why its reliability is high is because of the customer support which is provided by the UiPath team. I continuously discuss whenever we are building any automation with the UiPath team, means when our developers are doing any development, whenever they are stuck or whenever they need any help, the response from the central UiPath team is very quick. In fact, in our organization, they have scheduled a daily one-hour call in which they resolve any issue related to the coding or development which they are facing.

This helps in improving the confidence of a developer that even if they are stuck, it will help them in building the automation. The third reason why the UiPath has a good reliability is also it is able to work with the major automation ERP tools, which are SAP and Oracle. The configuration of the UiPath is built in such a way that many of the automations related to SAP, which is one of the biggest ERP being used by majority of the large organization, it has built those features that doing automation in SAP becomes easier in UiPath. There are some community forums or paths through which if any issue happens, or if somebody is not able to build any automation related to SAP, the team is able to find their answers on those community platforms.

Client 00:13:05

Makes sense. You also had mentioned that there is a kind of gap in low-code no-code. How significant is this disadvantage for UiPath, and which competitors have you seen handling the kind of non-technical use cases better?

Expert 00:13:20

This is one area in which the competitors of UiPath, I would say two competitors, have an edge over UiPath. If we talk about Automation Anywhere, it has slightly more edge over UiPath because the module or the interface is comparatively more easier for a person to build the development rather than for a new person, if I talk about. Microsoft Power Automate is way ahead, both Automation Anywhere and UiPath. It has built so easy low-code/no-code automation platforms that it is very easy for a user to automate their day-to-day activities. Another reason why Microsoft Power Automate is having an advantage is because whenever any automation has to be built related to, since most of the organization, they work in Microsoft environment only, and most of the people they work in Microsoft Excel or Office.

Microsoft Power Automate has already built such custom automations which are very easy to be deployed even by a person whose coding experience is very less. They are just drag and drop automations. Whereas since UiPath and Automation Anywhere are external to Microsoft environment, for them it is not so easy for the LCNC which are built for them. They are not easy for a person who does not have that good coding experience to build an automation on them. That is one reason. Apart from that, another reason is the learning platforms. There are multiple learning platforms which are available on multiple sources, be it the Microsoft website or they have also, if I talk about within our organization also.

There were some sessions which were conducted by Microsoft in order to promote their product. They had conducted some free learning session of the low-code no-code automation for the organization employees, and I am sure they might have done it for other organization also. Also some licenses, free of cost licenses for a limited period of time were offered so that employees could take interest and learn to build those low-code no-code tools on their own.

Client 00:15:32

That makes sense. If you were to force rank between UiPath, Power Automate, Automation Anywhere, and Blue Prism today for more complex enterprise-wide deployments, how would you rank them and why?

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Expert 00:15:46

You have asked me question related to two things. One is related to the complex enterprise-wide automation or on the ease of build. These are two different things. There are a number of decisions that need to be taken in building it. The first reason is the availability of developers who can build this automation. Honestly speaking, if I will start looking for RPA developers in the market, the developers who have Blue Prism experience, it is very rare to find them because that requires a good coding expert. It can build a robust tool with very less fallout, but I will not be able to find a developer, and it will take a lot of time for me. Obviously my next option would be Automation Anywhere.

My first option, if I have to give a ranking, first ranking I would give to Automation Anywhere, second ranking I would give to UiPath, third ranking I will give to Power Automate, and fourth ranking I will give to Blue Prism. The reason I am giving fourth ranking to Blue Prism is because it is not easy to find a developer who can build Blue Prism. There is a scarcity of such developers, and it is very high time-taking.

Client 00:17:04

I see. In the recent years, would you say any competitive advantage for UiPath against the other products has been widening, narrowing, or just stable?

Expert 00:17:14

I wouldn't say it is widening, but one thing which Automation Anywhere is doing, not on its product but on its marketing is, I know that Automation Anywhere and UiPath, they built their generative AI capability almost at the same time. Automation Anywhere was the first one who quickly went out to every organization and started telling them that, "Look, we have upgraded our automation from traditional RPA to a GenAI-based capability." They started holding sessions with every organization, meeting their solution architects to demonstrate their generative AI capability.

That kind of information from UiPath, or I would say their marketing was missing. Since I am a person who regularly interacts with my developers, I was aware that now UiPath has generative AI capability and is building the agentic AI version also. That marketing sense, or I would say reaching out to customers was less. Even though both the products have same competitive features, Automation was trying to do more marketing.

Client 00:18:19

Got it. I am curious, I know we talked about this a little bit before in terms of the orchestration and the importance of that, but do you think today companies actually have a problem with coordinating multiple AI agents and automation technologies such that they require a separate control layer?

Expert 00:18:38

Yes, they do have. The biggest issue which they have is in getting the AI security layer approved by their IT team. There are two kind of organizations. One is those organizations who are the captive organization or the main organization. If we talk about those organizations, only 20% organizations have focus to move towards emerging technologies. There are second type of organizations, which are service-based organizations, which are the business partners of those bigger organizations. Those organizations, like Accenture, they have a high focus on deploying the AI, I would say, atmosphere.

The major issue or the major roadblock that happens is whenever we reach out to most of our customers, their IT team, they have lots of cautions and apprehension about the data security related to any AI product. It takes a lot of time in getting everything approved by their AI governance team.

Client 00:19:41

Has that as a process been changing at all?

Expert 00:19:45

Yeah, I was saying that although organizations are enthusiastic about the new layer of AI, and every organization is focusing on the AI, developer tool and all. If we talk about their data security concerns, they still have some concerns related to data security. That is something that will take some more time for the organizations to evolve and adapt to the AI layer of automation.

Client 00:20:09

I see. From what we have seen so far, UiPath is now trying to become that neutral control layer for orchestration. Does that conceptually make sense to you, or does that seem like too far of an extension from what customers have historically purchased UiPath to do?

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Expert 00:20:26

No, it obviously makes conceptual sense for them on their orchestration layer and the module, and I think UiPath is going in the right direction for this, because this will become a need of the hour in some time.

Client 00:20:40

What capabilities do you think they need to provide for a customer to say, "Regardless of what AI agent we use, this should run through UiPath as an orchestration layer"?

Expert 00:20:51

If you talk about the capabilities which they have to provide, that depends on customer to customer, because it will not be one solution fits all. They have to understand it according to the industry type and region type. I will give you an example. An industry of logistic-based products in North America will have totally different requirement than an industry of consumer durable goods in Europe. An industry of hospitality in the Middle East will have totally different requirements. It will not be that one shoe fit all. If we look at the largest perspective of the capabilities which UiPath has to build, they should follow the example of some of the automation organizations which have partnered with their ERP vendors and provided an inbuilt solution so that the client does not have to add an add-on layer of the automation.

For example, I will give an example. ReadSoft is an optical character-based, OCR-based automation tool, which does the automation of invoice processing. ReadSoft, instead of going to directly selling their invoice processing tool to the customers, they have partnered with SAP and added a tool of ReadSoft-based invoice processing tool within itself. That is why whichever organization has SAP, it becomes very easy for them to reach out to them and sell their products. That kind of capabilities need to be built by UiPath, that currently it is working as a surface automation tool.

For every customer, UiPath looks like that this is something external. This is not a part of our existing systems. This is something which could be replaced with, for example, with the automation tool, which is an RPA competitor if another RPA competitor is coming at a lesser price, or I would say with a better capability. If they expand their capabilities of not being just a surface-based automation tool, they also integrate their automation layers within the ERPs which the organizations are currently using. I would say they will be able to scale up their product.

Client 00:23:00

Got it. How much value do you think will come from the orchestration layer itself compared to things like governance, auditability, security, and monitoring?

Expert 00:23:11

Orchestration layer will give a very high importance to this UiPath, because if you look at its competitor, Automation Anywhere, it already had that layer. It has its command center in which means all the similar features of orchestration are available. That is why when I ranked this UiPath, I gave one ranking higher to Automation Anywhere also. Obviously with this orchestration layer or the module, because these days, like I told, when human beings are not working, the agents would be working. Obviously, when agents are working, a need arises that how many agents are working, how many are not working, how many have been triggered for automation, what is their success rate? That level of visibility is currently not available manually. Obviously that orchestration is something which would be an added visibility that could be provided to its client in terms of the product's usage.

Client 00:24:07

Do you think UiPath's existing orchestrator footprint gives it a structural advantage in becoming that layer for orchestration? Alternatively, what would prevent someone like a Microsoft or ServiceNow or another AI-native platform from providing that control plane layer?

Expert 00:24:25

Currently, if we talk about Microsoft or any AI competitor, if we talk about the AI competitors, which are Claude, ChatGPT, and Google Gemini. These are the major competitors which are providing the AI-based automation to the enterprises. They have started giving them. Until now, that is the disadvantage they have. All their automations are available on a particular person's system, and they do not have visibility. Still, they are able to automate the activities of a particular individual only, but they are not able to automate the activities of an entire team, and that is why the governance is not there. The person has to manually see which of my agents are working or not, and even that visibility is very poor in the AI competitors of UiPath, I would say.

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Client 00:25:16

Do you think vendor neutrality matters enough, though, that customers would choose UiPath over an orchestration layer offered by one of their larger strategic software vendors as they continue to build these capabilities over time?

Expert 00:25:29

Vendor neutral in what aspect? Neutrality in what aspect?

Client 00:25:34

I am saying, would it make sense to use UiPath instead of using something from ServiceNow or Microsoft if you are heavily built into those company's capabilities already as an organization? Where is the value in that?

Expert 00:25:48

If I talk about ServiceNow, Microsoft, the biggest disadvantage with these tools is the automation scope in these services is very limited. They have the disadvantage that their products are not easily customizable. Whatever they have built is built. If they have done five automations and the customer is looking for a sixth automation, it is not possible in their regular products, and it becomes very time-consuming for the team. I will give you an example of ServiceNow only and quickly explain. If in ServiceNow, the team is getting the status, suppose, a ticket is being created by an email which is auto-generated email. If we have to ask ServiceNow, auto-generated emails should not be added as a ticket. That customization is not possible in ServiceNow, and for that, we have to use UiPath itself.

That trust and confidence in these service-based companies, which are ServiceNow, Salesforce, BlackLine, Cadency, is not there. That is why organization have to use the surface-based automation RPA tools, or like UiPath, Automation Anywhere to automate those activities which their service partners are not able to automate or are taking very high time to automate.

Client 00:27:07

Got it. UiPath now is allowing developers to use various coding agents, whether it is Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Copilot, while then having UiPath provide the runtime and governance. Do you think that architecture makes sense from a developer's perspective?

Expert 00:27:25

It does make sense from developer's perspective because they are able to save a lot of time in building those automations. Even most of my developers earlier, when they had to build some code, it used to take them, I will give you an example, the general or the estimated turnaround time for building a development earlier was four to six weeks. Now they are able to do it in two to three weeks. This has considerably saved a lot of time.

Client 00:27:52

Got it. If developers over time can increasingly generate automation through those coding agents, do you think that makes UiPath more important because it is supplying the production infrastructure or less important because building automation itself becomes easier?

Expert 00:28:10

Currently, if I talk about the practical use case, the developers are resorting to using the coding agents. That is why we are able to close our task. I will tell you about the governance model or the operating model of developer, how it has changed. Earlier, there were separate developers who were building the coding for different automation projects. Now, instead of having so many developers, two or three developers who have rich experience are using coding agents to do the same coding which were earlier being done by developers. It is obviously a good use case in which these capabilities of coding agents are being utilized by our agents. In fact, their supervisors are happy that all these codings are getting completed very fast.

Client 00:28:59

Right. What do you think UiPath adds after a coding agent has generated the underlying automation that would be difficult for a developer to reproduce elsewhere?

Expert 00:29:09

That is something I haven't gone into that deep detail of this, so I might not have the answer for this.

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Client 00:29:16

No worries. Do you think developers could simply use conventional software infrastructure and more of the open source orchestration tools instead, or is there something that UiPath is doing that solves a harder enterprise problem that couldn't be addressed through those other solutions?

Expert 00:29:33

First of all, open source automation is not encouraged in our organization because we have very strict policy related to the data confidentiality breach. A developer cannot use any open source automation. They have to build everything within the prescribed automation infrastructure which is assigned to them. Suppose for a particular client, if we have UiPath as the designated automation infrastructure, they can build every automation in UiPath only. Even if it is a small project or is a big project, they cannot use any Python coding or another coding because they are not approved from IT and security compliance.

Client 00:30:12

Got it. It is really more of a limitation of the organization than a functionality limitation.

Expert 00:30:18

Not a functionality limitation. This is a data compliance limitation because I cannot allow every developer to use whatever automation they want to use. We want them to use, like I said, if for a particular project, UiPath is the approved infrastructure, then they can build all the automation within UiPath itself. They are able to because it has all the features to do automation.

Client 00:30:45

Right. UiPath is basically the orchestration layer now for third-party coding agents. Does that make its position stronger because there are more workloads that are ultimately being run on top of UiPath, or is it weaker because this hidden orchestration layer and the developers are actually interacting with another coding vendor's development interface?

Expert 00:31:07

That depends on the knowledge of the developer also. Because if the developer who is building the third-party coding agents has knowledge of the workflows related to that, then they are able to build a better customized solution, which is able to make the end product more towards the actual requirement. That is indeed helpful for the developers.

Client 00:31:30

Got it. From what you have seen, once UiPath is deeply deployed, what are the biggest barriers for a customer to switching?

Expert 00:31:38

If you talk about the customer, the biggest barrier for a customer to switch in is on training its developer or the team to utilize that tool for automation. Likewise, I told, UiPath is a tool which requires a person who has prior coding experience in UiPath to build that. That is one requirement. Second is if they have to upskill their existing development team who are working on some other platform, or if they are already using Automation Anywhere or Power Automate, it is not that difficult for them to switch to UiPath if they are already using it. There is not much of a difference between these tools and within a week or so, any developer who is doing automation on Automation Anywhere can shift to UiPath very easily.

If I talk about if they were already using Power Automate, and if they will shift to UiPath, it will take much longer time of three to four weeks or even higher for making them shift. There are two cases. I was talking related to adoption of customer. First is if the client already had some RPA tool, then it is very easy. UiPath is very easy to understand. If that automation is totally new for the client, the first challenge they find is how to find the POCs with relevant experience of UiPath for them. The second challenge which they face is how to upskill them or continuously upgrade them so that they are in tandem with the upgradation of the tools.

Client 00:33:11

Right. Do you think adding Maestro and agentic orchestration to a UiPath deployment makes the switching cost meaningfully higher for a customer?

Expert 00:33:19

I think your question is that if the AI orchestration module is added to UiPath, will that make the switching cost more, I would say, a better case for the customer? Is that what you are asking?

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Client 00:33:33
I am asking effectively, does adding this orchestration layer make UiPath products stickier?

Expert 00:33:41
It is. Obviously, it is much better. It will become a better case indeed for a customer.

Client 00:33:48
Do you think customers adopting agentic capabilities will spend more materially with UiPath, or is this more of a way to defend existing automation spend from customers that are moving into AI instead of traditional RPA?

Expert 00:34:03
There is another factor that needs to be taken into consideration. It is not just adopting to AI that is important to the customer, although everyone is talking about AI and switching to agentic AI is something which they are looking for. The factor which they have to look into is whether it is making a good ROI case for them or not. Doing automation with the traditional RPA is very low cost. If they compare it with their existing human cost, then traditional RPA is very low cost. Its run cost is very low, its deployment cost is very low. When the agentic layer is added into the automation, its cost becomes very high and its run costs become much, much higher. Obviously, there are two factors related to this. One is aspirational, and second is the ground reality.

Aspirationally, yes, everybody wants to move to the AI-based automation layer or agentic layer of the UiPath. On ground, they also see or they evaluate whether moving it to this will become cheaper for them, or will it become so costly for them that it will ultimately become a much higher cost product for them than something they could have done manually. Aspirationally, they want to, but based on the business case, they have to look into it. What is it actually doing for them? That depends on customer to customer. There are some customers who have put aside some additional budget for the AI transformation. Obviously, they will not take into mind such upgradation. But those customers who aspire to go for AI but have not kept aside any budget for it, obviously, they would think twice or thrice before making that switch.

Client 00:35:56
What would demonstrate to you that UiPath has successfully moved from an RPA vendor to a broader strategic automation platform that will benefit from AI?

Expert 00:36:06
Obviously, it will.

Client 00:36:08
What would give you confidence that transition has happened?

Expert 00:36:11
Like I told, the traditional automation cost is very less. Sometimes it happens. I will give you an example. If my cost of doing something is taking me a monthly cost of $2,000 or $3,000 per month, then in that case, using the traditional, and if that is very logic-based, then if I will use a UiPath tool, I will have to pay for once on the infrastructure, and then the license cost is very less. That is close to, I would say, $200 or $300 per month. AI, for the same case, if we are using AI, its cost becomes $1,000 or $1,200 per month or even more. Sometimes it is $3,000 to $4,000 also per month. That is the case in which the client makes a strategic decision whether they are doing automation at a large scale or at a small scale.

For small scale, traditional RPA works, and if you are doing it a larger scale, obviously they will resort to AI. Managing traditional will not be easy with that, and that is where the orchestration will come into effect, or I would say, as a good use case.

Client 00:37:26
Got it. In your view, over the next three to five years, which competitor or category poses the greatest threat to UiPath?

Expert 00:37:34
First is Automation Anywhere. Second is Power Automate. Third is Claude. Although I do not see it as a competitor or a competitor to UiPath right now or for some years, but just in case, if they start exploring the other aspects of doing the automation related to the core

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activities, then it may pose as a threat. In that case, then all the three AI-based, which is ChatGPT, OpenAI, Claude, and Gemini, they all may become a threat if UiPath does not upgrade its AI capability at par with them.

Client 00:38:11

Got it. Thanks for making the time for a call today. Thank you very much. Have a good one. Bye.

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